

A Worry-Free Number

Do you ever worry about the price of a pack of gum? Of course not. The cost is so insignificant that it won't affect you.

This is the power of a Worry-Free Number, or a number that's so small, it's not even worth thinking about. We can use this concept to be more intentional about what we *should* focus on.

The gum example makes sense, no matter what your financial situation is. A \$2 pack of gum? Who cares? But as our finances grow, we rarely update our Worry-Free Number. I speak to lots of millionaires who still obsess over the price of an extra pair of headphones or a nice webcam for their home office. Proportionally, those headphones cost the same as the gum.

By picking a Worry-Free Number, you free yourself from these tiny concerns so you can focus on what's really important. That number could be \$5, \$50, or even \$5,000.

For example:

- » If it's \$5, you're not going to worry about the price of a latte.
- » If it's \$50, you don't need to worry about taking an Uber to the airport.
- » If it's \$5,000, you won't think twice about flying first class on your next trip.

A good rule of thumb for your Worry-Free Number is how much you make in one hour. To calculate that, take your annual income, divide it by two, and knock off the three zeros. If your annual income is \$60,000, you make \$30 an hour: $\$60,000 \div 2 = \$30,000$, or \$30/hour.

That's where your Worry-Free Number starts. Adjust as necessary.